

Alzheimer's patients, take heart. Intel's inside

Intel claims that it can employ wireless sensors to track the lifestyle of 11 patients in the early stages of the Alzheimer's disease.

In its new project, Intel will place off-the-shelf sensors that wirelessly transmit data to a computer—in kitchens, bathrooms, phones and computers in households. The data will then be crunched to measure the amount of time a patient spends on the phone, talking to visitors or e-mailing. Intel will then formulate a 'sociability index', primarily to gauge cognitive decline.

Intel pledged \$1 million when it created a consortium with the Alzheimer's Associa-

tion last July called Everyday Technologies for Alzheimer Care. ETAC is now reviewing 40 applicants from academia



and hopes to raise a total \$4 million (Rs 18.5 crore) in June from other technology companies.

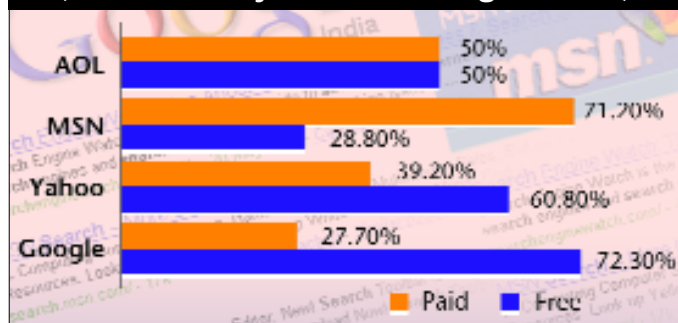
If the system works, the technology will be placed in 200 US households by 2005.

statattack

Most Popular Non-Work Related Web Sites Accessed at the Office



Most Relevant Search Result (Determined by % of Search Engine Users)



Source: iProspect, Survey Sampling International, WebSurveyor, and Stratagem Research

How cheap can a download be?

Sony recently launched the Sits Connect online music store in the US with the promise of "a better selection than any other legal download service". However, the Washington Post slammed what it called an "embarrassment to the parent company" and its "control-freak behaviour".

It has only 5,00,000 titles, compared to Apple iTunes's 7,00,000. Like iTunes, Connect supports a limited array of portable music players, in this case Sony's MiniDisc machines. Connect encodes songs in its own 132 Kbps ATRAC 3 format, offering them for 99c a track, or at \$10 an album.

Sony is not going to find it easy in Europe, though, especially since it's likely to merge with another music giant, Bertelsmann Music Group (BMG). A Sydney Morning Herald reporter, incidentally, has discovered a Russian site that offers downloads for as little as 5 cents a track (or Rs 3 per song).

Let the air in; open the Windows!

Microsoft has, for obvious reasons, been on the forefront of the oppose-open-source campaign. Not anymore. If officials of the Redmond-headquartered software giant are to be believed, Microsoft will let the world peek into the world's highest selling desktop operating system. Last month, Microsoft posted the Windows Template library at SourceForge (www.soundforge.net).

This is the second time that Microsoft has shared bits of

redalert

W32/Lovgate.ab

This worm attempts to reply to all messages in Microsoft Outlook. It scans files for e-mail addresses, and uses its own SMTP engine to send itself to the address it finds. The 'From' line of the e-mail is spoofed. It also attempts to copy itself to KaZaA shared folders, and all computers on a local network and terminates processes belonging to anti-virus programs.

Version 1.1.6 of the W32.HLLW.Lovgate@mm is available for downloading at the Symantec Web site www.symantec.com

Sasser Scare

W32.Sasser.B.Worm is a variant of W32.Sasser.Worm.

It spreads by scanning randomly selected IP addresses for vulnerable systems. Interestingly, no more than one instance of the worm can run on a computer at any time. Symantec's removal tool is available at <http://security.response.symantec.com/avcenter/FxSasser.exe>.

Windows. Earlier in April, the company revealed the source code for its Windows installer XML software, WiX.

WiX builds installation packages for Windows software using XML (eXtensible Markup Language). Of course, in typical Microsoft Janus-faced approach, it has revealed quite a bit of Windows to countries such as China, to assuage their security concerns.

The current program includes only a few countries, only after signing of confiden-

